

Your first Agent

LESSON 02 · MODULE 1 — FOUNDATIONS

What you'll learn

- The role each of the five `create_agent` parameters plays
- The mental shortcut: role is identity, goal is direction, instructions are behavior
- How `temperature` actually changes model behavior (and when it doesn't)
- What fields live on the response object beyond `.response`
- Which response field matters for memory work later in the course

Key concepts

Pick descriptive names. `my-assistant` is fine for a demo. For real work, `support-triage-bot` is what shows up in Studio and in your logs. The name is for *you*, not the user.

Role vs goal vs instructions. Role is one sentence describing what the agent *is* — `customer support agent`, `senior python engineer`, `travel concierge`. Role sets voice. Goal is what it's trying to *achieve* — `help customers resolve issues`, `review code for correctness and style`. Goal orients every response. Instructions are the specific behavior rules — `be empathetic, concise, and solution-oriented`. Instructions tune tone and behavior. **If your agent isn't behaving how you'd like, 90% of the time it's one of these three fields.**

Temperature is the one optional knob worth knowing. Range 0 to 2, default 0.7. Low temperature plays it safe — predictable, repetitive, close to the model's single most likely answer. High temperature takes more risks — creative, varied, sometimes weirder. **Caveat:** temperature only moves behavior when there are lots of good answers to pick from. Ask for the definition of recursion and the model lands in the same sentence regardless. Ask for a metaphor for recursion and you see the spread.

Temperature in practice. Drop it below 0.7 for factual, consistent answers. Raise it above 0.7 for creative work — brainstorming, naming, copywriting. Crank it too high and you get nonsense. Don't touch it unless you have a reason.

The response object is more than text. `response.response` is the answer. `response.session_id` is the conversation thread this response belongs to — it matters when we get to memory.

TAKEAWAY

Pick descriptive names.

TAKEAWAY

Role vs goal vs instructions.

TAKEAWAY

Temperature is the one optional knob worth knowing.

TAKEAWAY

Temperature in practice.

TAKEAWAY

The response object is more than text.

`message_id` and `metadata` come back as `None` for now; they populate in specific cases covered later.

Code shown in this lesson

PYTHON

```
agent = studio.create_agent(
    name="support-triage-bot",
    provider="gpt-4o",
    role="customer support agent",
    goal="help customers resolve issues",
    instructions="Be empathetic, concise, and solution-oriented.",
)
```

PYTHON

```
# Optional knob: temperature
agent = studio.create_agent(
    name="creative-writer",
    provider="gpt-4o",
    role="creative writing partner",
    goal="generate vivid metaphors",
    instructions="Be imaginative.",
    temperature=1.5,
)
```

PYTHON

```
response = agent.run("Give me a metaphor for recursion.")
print(response.response)
print(response.session_id) # save this for memory work later
```

TRY THIS

- 1 Build a code-reviewer agent. `role="senior python engineer"`, `goal="review code for correctness and style"`, `instructions="Always explain your reasoning before giving code."` Feed it a five-line Python function with a deliberate off-by-one bug and see whether the agent catches it.
- 2 Run the recursion-metaphor prompt three times at `temperature=0` and three times at `temperature=1.8`. Note which temperature produced repetition and which produced range. Then try `temperature=1.0` and see where it lands.